

Daily Bible Note

Date: May 22, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 7:1–16

1 Now concerning the things of which you wrote to me: It is good for a man not to touch a woman.

2 Nevertheless, because of sexual immorality, let each man have his own wife, and let each woman have her own husband.

3 Let the husband render to his wife the affection due her, and likewise also the wife to her husband.

4 The wife does not have authority over her own body, but the husband does. And likewise the husband does not have authority over his own body, but the wife does.

5 Do not deprive one another except with consent for a time, that you may give yourselves to fasting and prayer; and come together again so that Satan does not tempt you because of your lack of self-control.

6 But I say this as a concession, not as a commandment.

7 For I wish that all men were even as I myself. But each one has his own gift from God, one in this manner and another in that.

8 But I say to the unmarried and to the widows: It is good for them if they remain even as I am;

9 but if they cannot exercise self-control, let them marry. For it is better to marry than to burn with passion.

10 Now to the married I command, yet not I but the Lord: A wife is not to depart from her husband.

11 But even if she does depart, let her remain unmarried or be reconciled to her husband. And a husband is not to divorce his wife.

12 But to the rest I, not the Lord, say: If any brother has a wife who does not believe, and she is willing to live with him, let him not divorce her.

13 And a woman who has a husband who does not believe, if he is willing to live with her, let her not divorce him.

14 For the unbelieving husband is sanctified by the wife, and the unbelieving wife is sanctified by the husband; otherwise your children would be unclean, but now they are holy.

15 But if the unbeliever departs, let him depart; a brother or a sister is not under bondage in such cases. But God has called us to peace.

16 For how do you know, O wife, whether you will save your husband? Or how do you know, O husband, whether you will save your wife?

II. Key Summary

- Both marriage and singleness are gifts from God — neither is more spiritual than the other. What matters is which one you've been given, and living faithfully within it
 - Marriage is built on mutual obligation to give, not take. Paul uses the word "defraud" (same as in 6:8) — withholding affection from your spouse is actually cheating them
 - A believer's presence in a home quietly creates an environment where God can work — even an unbelieving spouse or children are drawn into a sphere of God's care
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III. Passage Analysis

Marriage Is About Giving, Not Getting

"The emphasis is on giving, on 'I owe you' instead of 'you owe me.' In God's heart, sex is put on a much higher level than merely the husband's privilege and the wife's duty." [1]

Paul uses the word "defraud" (same Greek word as in 1 Corinthians 6:8) — when you withhold affection from your spouse, you're cheating them out of something they're owed. This flips the usual way we think about relationships: instead of asking "what do I get?" the question becomes "what do I owe you?"

One Believer Can Shape the Whole Family

"The unbelieving spouse is affiliated to the Christian community... in virtue of his being 'one flesh' with his Christian wife, set apart for a special working in their lives by the Holy

The word "sanctified" in verse 14 doesn't mean the unbeliever is automatically saved — it means that living close to someone who genuinely follows Jesus puts them within reach of God's work in a unique way. For anyone who feels alone in their faith at home, this is a quiet encouragement: your presence matters more than you know.

IV. Reflection Question

Is there someone close to you — a family member, a friend — who doesn't believe? Does your faith ever show up around them, or do you keep it out of sight?

Paul asks, "How do you know you won't save your family member?" — maybe that's not pressure, but an invitation: keep being who you are, and trust that it matters.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik Commentary on 1 Corinthians 7,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-7/>

[2] BibleHub.com, Vincent's Word Studies (Commentary on 1 Corinthians 7:14),
https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/7-14.htm